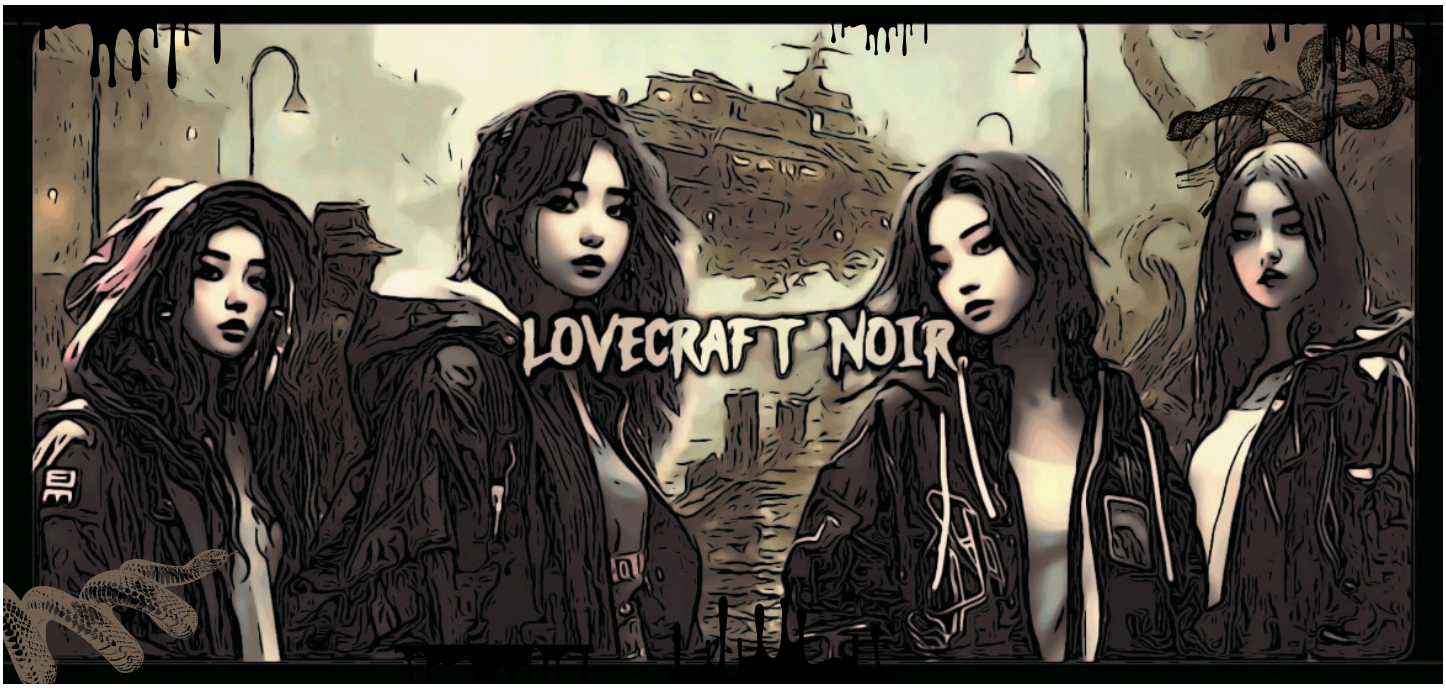
Dwellers of the Unknown

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Tales of Cosmic Systems

http://github.com/Lovecraft-noir



Overview

Before atoms, before particles, before stars - there are **rules**

The Laws

Constraints create patterns
Patterns create structure
Structures create systems

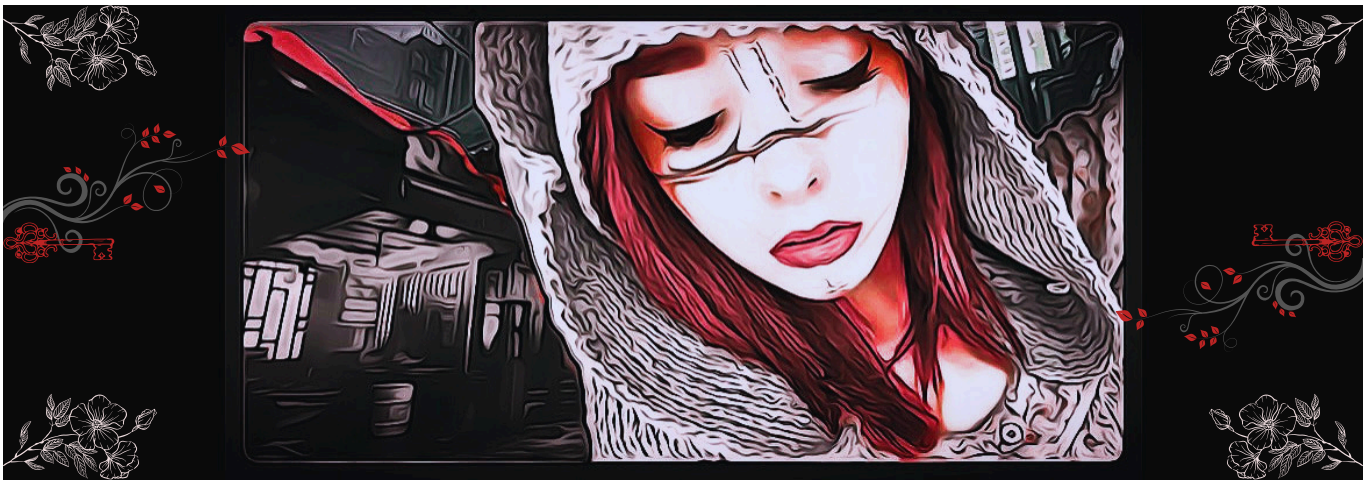
This is the cosmic origin - the seed of every system
The cosmic born from human behavior
When a system becomes cosmic it stops needing individuals
Thus becoming the indifference

A loss of humanity



The Heiress was still reeling from being knocked down. The attack had come without warning — blunt, territorial, a shove meant to remind her where she stood. Several girls circled, each step announcing their presence with deliberate, predatory calm. Even though still in shock that dulled her senses, she felt their aura imposed upon her: dominance, judgment, indifference. It radiated off them. The same flagrant dismissal as an introduction. This wasn't their first meeting. The girls had been pecking at her since she began moving through the local sprawl, turning both business and leisure into a disenchanting culture shock. No matter how carefully she tried to defuse their hostility, her presence in this foreign city drew a peculiar kind of prejudice— not loud, not dramatic. just constant. It clung to her like an uneasy reminder that she did not belong to the unspoken rules that governed this place.

The atmosphere shifted with quiet certainty of a leaf settling onto a puddle— disturbing its reflection in a way the water could not ignore. A calm entered the space, thin at first, then unmistakable. The girls who's footsteps retreated slightly, revealing their internal instincts as their feet began to shift in direction. A presence had taken residence among them, shadowed yet absolute, and the hostility that had ruled the moment faltered as if unsure of its own authority.



"I'd appreciate if you wouldn't have your war at my place of business."
A sudden voice resonated within the moment and the mayhem.



"You speak global trade language? I need of your business."
Standing before the Heiress was a sharp clothed gentleman who also wore the harsh reality of living near the port harbor. One who stands outside during it's winds or to bask under the moon as one of the wild children more accustomed to shadow than sun.

"Of course. I studied in the states. Look, I'm not for tourism. Nor am I cultural export. Who sent you?"
The Occultist began observing this pale skinned and sharp eyed individual. The paint she wore was as extravagant as the young woman's hair. Her clothes were not of these lands. They looked like they were fine material made from the finest animals. Her voice was even finer. Warm, dignified, unconfrontational.

"I sent myself to see you personally. I'm seeking your intuition on a matter that concerns my family."
She asked earnestly, not giving a moment of concern on the girls that previously blind sided her.

"Shouldn't you be calling the police?"
He spoke with conserve, restraint, and a hint of weariness—none of which touched the faint, warm smile he offered. It sat in stark contrast to his dark, fearless eyes.

"I have done so and they found nothing. Yet, I notice things maybe you can decipher better than I."
Her voice clipped sharply, carrying its own strain and desperation. Not demanding, but undeniably present. Her eyes met his, matching his presence and his fearlessness with a resolve of her own.

"What kind of things?"
His eyes peered with curiosity—not suspicion, but measuring, as if her urgency itself were a sincerity he was trying to read. He let the silence stand, not to pressure her, but to see whether she understood what kind of answer a man in his trade would require.

"So you're willing to help? There were cultural patterns I'm unfamiliar with. I know it's there."
Her voice carried a tone to push her case forward—more the kind that came from finally finding someone who might understand. She offered the information carefully, the way someone does when they've seen others speak of a man of mystery and good faith in one who can make sense of what is unseen.

"Maybe we should introduce ourselves first. Once I know who I'm dealing with—and what you're connected to—then I'll know whether you have a case worth looking into."
He didn't say it dismissively. His words fell humble— la respect to the craft, a necessary threshold before anything deeper could be named. Around him, the fireflies began to glow and gather as if nature's jury became present within the evening where the shadows loitered the corners the street lights could not reach, shifting as an audience.

He observed this youth and it was clear she wasn't naïve or inexperienced. The young woman carried a weight that wasn't ego or ideology but something much more meaningful. She spoke with the steadiness of someone raised well, someone who had learned to carry both her father and mother's worth. An accused soul worth advocating for.

The two learned much about one another. Dahgir spoke of his work, his travels, the doubts that had followed him through every old tradition he'd studied—beliefs, histories, and the strange architecture of meaning that stitched the world together. He talked the pattern of dreams, knowing the weight of patterns, considering every factor that shapes reality into being.

In turn, Kyee introduced herself. She explained her place in the upper echelon, her distance from the local world, and the reasons she had come here at all—steps she was taking to honor the time approaching when she would inherit her father's place in the family business. She spoke of her fears, as well: what the business might inherently be entangled itself with, and whether her father had understood the depth of it, even in her father's silence and commitment to the work.

Hours passed in that moment. Their words held a weight of something lived, something considered and possibly costly clues to what would be revealed.

When silence finally settled, Dahgir stayed quiet. His eyes drifted—not away from her, but inward—scanning the corridors of his own past, the doubts that had once shaken his understanding of the occult. The trails of secrets he had followed, and the things that guarded those secrets, felt suddenly close and aware.

Kyee watched him intently. She could sense the seriousness of what she had asked simply by the shift in his posture. Not the demeanor of a grifter, not the performance of someone selling mystique, but the steadiness of a man who sifted each case carefully and trusted only those who presented themselves with sincerity. A grit most grifters never possessed, not even an ounce of it in their hustle.



“The Accordance”